How to Setup a Driver

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1 Placing a Player Train

Continuing from document 6.01, enter the scenario by clicking the scenario name from the route menu and selecting Edit.

The scenario will load and the camera will be positioned near the scenario marker. Initially you will want to place a train and add a driver. To place a locomotive, click the Engines and Tenders button on the middle tab. You will be presented with a list of all available engines and tenders.

Left click a locomotive from the list so that the name becomes highlighted. You can then move the mouse onto the main screen and the selected locomotive will be attached to the cursor. Move the locomotive over the tracks and the loco will become sticky to it.

Left click once again to confirm the placement. You will need to add a tender to the locomotive if it is a steam locomotive.

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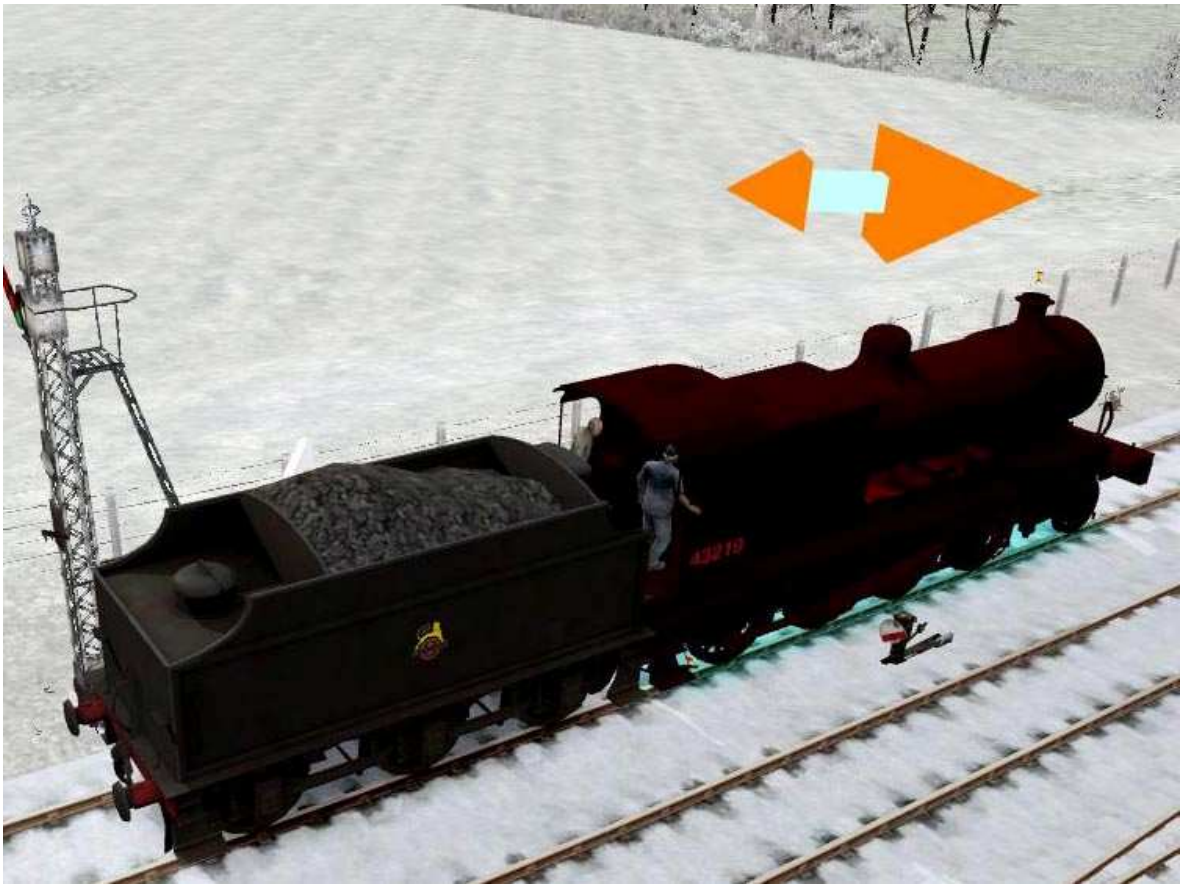
You can choose to add passenger or freight wagons in the same way from the Rolling Stock button next to the Engines and Tenders button.

To change the direction in which the train is facing, click the part of the train you want to flip (you can hold down the Control key to multiple select additional rolling stock). You will notice an orange arrow above the train.



The large end of the arrow shows the direction the train is facing. Click the arrow to flip the selected rolling stock to the opposite direction.

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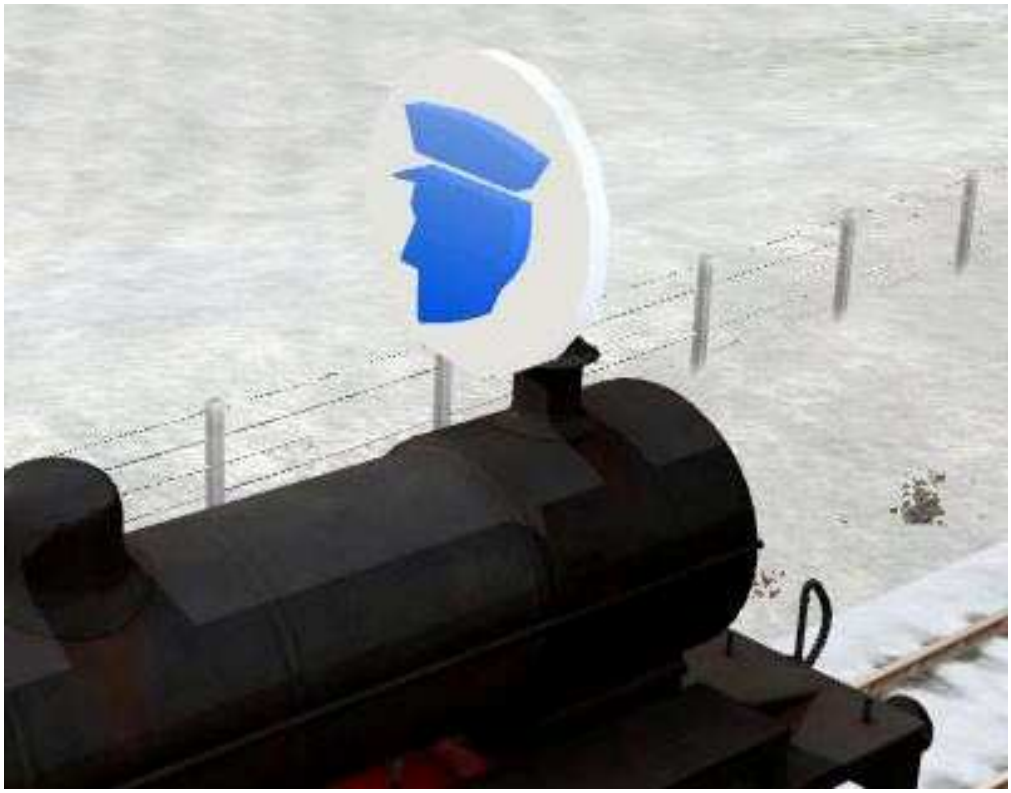
2 Adding a Driver

Now that the train has been placed you need to give it a driver. Select the driver icon from the upper tab then click the locomotive.

A disc is now sitting at the front of the locomotive showing a driver icon.



Now that a driver has been assigned to the train, the driver needs to be given some properties before the train can be driven.

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3 Driver Properties

To edit the driver properties, double left click the driver marker on the locomotive. This will reveal a properties tab on the right hand side of the screen. You will probably want to pin this tab so that it is permanently visible by clicking the pin icon.

Currently all the fields on the properties tab are filled with the default values. To edit a field, left click on it and type in new text or values with the keyboard. Holding your mouse cursor over the icon beside each field will bring up a descriptive tool tip.

Set Destination will be explained in the next section.

The bottom field, Service Class, is a pull down menu.

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Below is a list of each field and a description of what they mean:

Driver Name: This is the name which is displayed above the train, and is an identifier for the train. This name should be unique.

Player Consist: This is a check box. Checking the box means it is the player train. Leaving the box empty means the train is an AI (Artificial Intelligence) train. You will need to check this box if you intend to drive it.

Set Destination: This field does not accept manual text input and is described in more detail in the next section.

Start Time: This is the time the train begins its operation based on other scenario instructions. A time earlier than the Start Time of the scenario (as set in the scenario marker) is not valid. For a player train the start time should be the same as the scenario start time and is filled in as such automatically.

For AI trains you may want to stagger the start times so that trains begin their operations later. You do this by simply entering a later start time.

Service Class: This is a drop down list where you select the service class of the train. This determines the priority of the train and is used by the dispatcher. For example, an Express Passenger train has line priority over a Standard Freight, and a Special train has priority over all.

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4 Set Destination

This field has different functionality depending on whether the train is a player or AI train.

To set the destination you first click the blue box Set Destination icon then select a valid destination in the world editor. A valid destination can be a platform marker, a siding marker, a destination marker or a portal.

If the train is AI then setting a destination is the simplest form of instruction and potentially the only instruction that is needed.

The AI train will find a path to the destination, as long as there is a valid way to reach that destination, and will make its way to that destination from the driver start time. Once it has reached the destination it will stop.

For a player train you can leave this blank for now and you will be able to drive your train. When you get to set up more complex instructions for the player train the destination should be set the same as the destination on the final instruction.

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5 Drive Your Train

Now you have set up the scenario marker, placed a train and added a driver you have the basics to drive the train.

Your train has no complex scenario instructions yet and these will be described in later documents; however you can now drive the train by entering drive mode.

Below is a simple list containing the basics needed to get a player train driving in a new scenario:

* Place a scenario marker, double click the marker and edit the properties.
* Place a locomotive on the track
* Add a driver to the locomotive and assign properties to the driver
* Press play to enter drive mode.

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